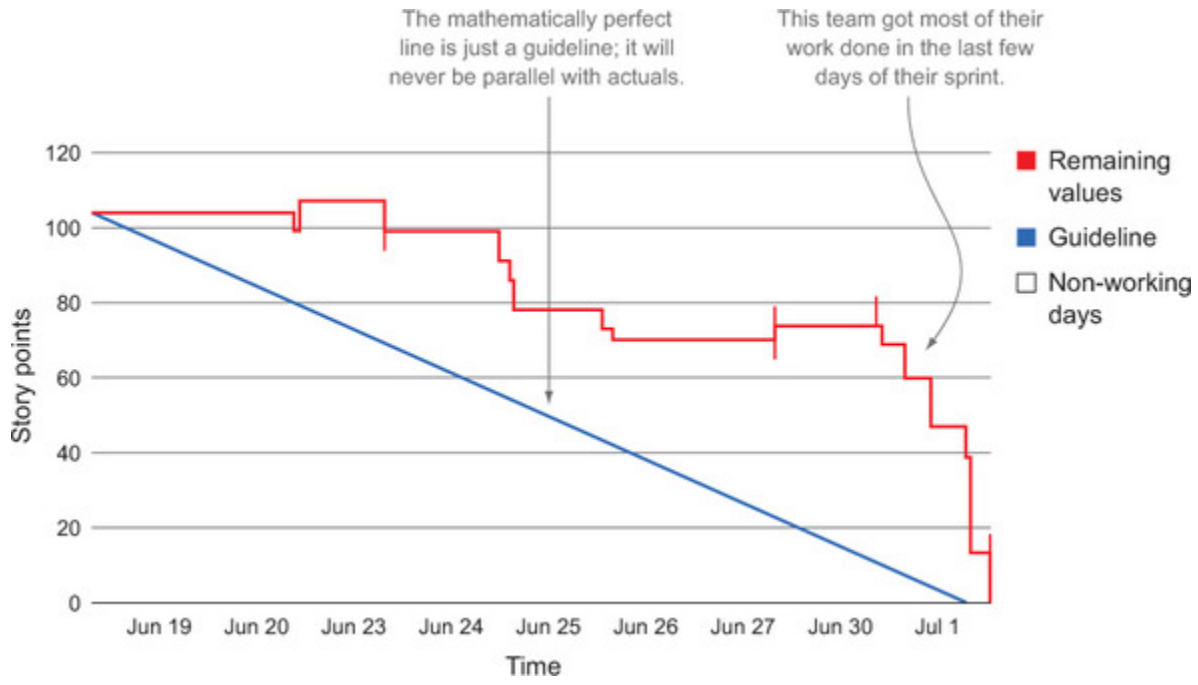


Burn down is very popular, but its value is limited due to the empirical nature of agile development. You will never have a smooth curve, and even though it's used as a guideline, its value is overestimated. So much so in fact that many Scrum coaches are deprecating the use of the burn down chart, and its use on agile teams is starting to diminish. Although it does provide a guideline to where you are against your commitment for a time period, burn down alone can't give you the whole story.

3.1.2. Velocity

Velocity is a relative measurement that tracks the consistency of a team's completed estimates over time. The idea with velocity is that a team should be able to consistently complete their work as they define it. An example velocity chart is shown in figure 3.3.

Figure 3.3. Velocity example